The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter

Photograph: AP

The man alleged to have carried out a shooting at the **White House Correspondents' Association** dinner on Saturday will be charged on Monday, officials said. Thirty-one-year-old Cole Tomas Allen had reportedly written a manifesto in which he promised to target Trump administration officials, "prioritised from highest-ranking to lowest". Donald Trump—unnamed, but the likely target of the foiled attack—said the perpetrator was an "anti-Christian" and "pretty sick guy".

Abbas Araghchi, **Iran's** foreign minister, arrived in **Russia** where he is expected to meet Vladimir Putin to discuss the war in Iran. Mr Trump said that if Iran's leaders wanted to make a deal they only had to call. Elsewhere, Lebanese officials said an Israeli airstrike killed 14 people, the deadliest attack since a ceasefire came into force.

Oil prices rose slightly as the prospect of peace diminished. Brent crude, the global benchmark, jumped by around 2.5% during early trading, before falling slightly. But Asian shares rose, with indices in Japan and South Korea hitting record highs. Meanwhile profits at big Chinese industrial firms increased by 15.8% in March, compared with a year earlier, the biggest jump in six months.

Naftali Bennett and Yair Lapid, two former **Israeli** prime ministers, merged their parties in an attempt to topple **Binyamin Netanyahu** in upcoming elections. The right-wing Mr Bennett will lead the unified party, called "Together". Mr Lapid, the centrist opposition leader, said the alliance would "put an end to internal divisions". Both men have been critical of Mr Netanyahu's leadership during Israel's wars.

An apparent suicide bombing killed **Mali**'s defence minister, Sadio Camara, at his home near Bamako, the capital. The killing came during one of the largest co-ordinated attacks by Islamic rebel groups in recent years. They included strikes on an international airport and towns farther north. The government has not announced a death toll, but declared two days of national mourning.

Thom Tillis, a Republican member of the Senate banking committee, said he would support **Kevin Warsh's** appointment as chair of the **Federal Reserve**. Mr Tillis had threatened to block Mr Warsh's nomination while the Department of Justice continued its spurious investigation into Jerome Powell, the outgoing chair. Mr Tillis saw it as a threat to the central bank's independence. The DoJ abandoned its probe on Friday.

Sabastian Sawe became the first person to run a **sub-two-hour marathon** in race conditions. The 31-year-old Kenyan completed the London marathon in one hour, 59 minutes and 30 seconds. Yomif Kejelcha, an Ethiopian who came second, also finished in under two hours. In 2019 Eliud Kipchoge, another Kenyan, achieved the same feat, but because he used a team of pacemakers the record was not official.

Figure of the day: *$150,000*, the auction price of a four-foot-tall Labubu doll, a toy at the centre of a strange speculative bubble. Read the full story.

Photograph: AFP

Elon Musk and Sam Altman battle in court

A trial worthy of Hollywood is about to begin in California. The world's richest man, Elon Musk, will face off against Sam Altman, boss of the world's most famous AI company. Mr Musk helped set up OpenAI, the firm behind ChatGPT, as a non-profit venture in 2015, but departed in 2018. He argues that Mr Altman (and others) went against that founding principle by shifting to a profit-driven structure. He wants OpenAI and Microsoft, one of its backers, to pay more than $134bn in damages—to go to OpenAI's charitable arm, he says—and remove Mr Altman and Greg Brockman, another co-founder. OpenAI claims this is a baseless attempt by a weaker rival (Mr Musk owns xAI as part of SpaceX, his rocket company) to undermine the industry front-runner.

Both billionaires are expected to testify. A verdict may take weeks. Betting markets don't much fancy Mr Musk's chances. The jury, selected on Monday, can expect some drama with their duty.

Photograph: U.S. Central Command

Stasis in the Strait

Bahrain, currently president of the UN Security Council, will chair a meeting on maritime security on Monday. The issue is crucial for both the kingdom and its neighbours in the Gulf, but the meeting will only highlight their powerlessness. The Strait of Hormuz is still blockaded by both America and Iran. On average four ships make it through each day (down from around 125 normally). Gulf states want allies to send warships as escorts. That looks unlikely before the war ends.

And a conclusion does not seem imminent. Abbas Araghchi, the Iranian foreign minister, has spent recent days in Pakistan, which has been trying to mediate a deal, but has refused to meet the Americans. The American delegation hasn't turned up at all—the country's diplomats say that they remain unsatisfied with Mr Araghchi's latest proposal for ending the war. The coming days may bring a fresh round of talks. Until then, the standoff continues.

Photograph: Getty Images

An awkward royal visit

The ideal time for a state visit is not shortly after a possible assassination attempt on the host. But even before a gunman stormed the White House correspondents' dinner on Saturday, King Charles III's trip to America, which begins on Monday, had diplomats on edge. The visit, ostensibly for the 250th anniversary of American independence, has become a mission to save the "special relationship".

Donald Trump resents British objections to his foreign forays, particularly in Iran. Meanwhile, Sir Keir Starmer, Britain's prime minister, is "fed up" with the economic impact of the president's actions. And polling suggests the American and British publics are souring on each other's countries, too. Mr Trump is a fan of Britain's royal family: he described his stay at Windsor Castle with King Charles in September as "one of the highest honours" of his life. But pomp and pageantry can go only so far in healing a rift.

Photograph: Getty Images

South Africa’s precarious progress

Monday is “Freedom Day”, when South Africans celebrate the anniversary of the first elections in which all races could vote in 1994. Much has improved in the 32 years since. The country now has a basic welfare state and a larger black middle class. More South Africans socialise across racial lines; two-thirds say they would support the best person for president, regardless of race. The economy—moribund for at least a decade—has recently shown signs of life, partly because of belated reforms to state-owned enterprises such as Eskom, the utility company.

But war in the Gulf has slowed that momentum; South Africa’s reliance on imported fuel makes it vulnerable to rising prices. Though somewhat tempered by a coalition government since 2024, the ruling African National Congress party is still plagued by corruption and incompetence. On April 23rd the president suspended the head of police, the latest powerful figure embroiled in alleged graft. South Africa has come far; it has much further to go.

Illustration: Sandra Navarro

Daily quiz

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to . We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Monday: Which character is the main archenemy of the Fantastic Four, in both the comic book and film series?

The beginning is always today.

Mary Wollstonecraft